SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #46 · MIRACLES & BLESSING

# “If I had enough faith, God would have healed me.”

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## Where it often comes from

Teaching that God always heals when faith is strong enough. Being told your illness continues because you doubt. Seeing others healed and wondering what is wrong with you. Praying hard for healing that has not come. Well-meaning people who said, “Just believe and you’ll be well.”

## What Scripture teaches

God can heal, and we are free to ask Him. But Scripture does not teach that every illness lasts because of weak faith. Paul, a man of great faith, pleaded three times for his thorn to be removed, and God answered, “My grace is sufficient for you.” Paul left his co-worker Trophimus sick in Miletus. God works all things together for good for those who love Him, sometimes by healing and sometimes by giving strength in weakness.

> *“Three times I pleaded with the Lord to take it away from me. But He said to me, ‘My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.’ Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me”* **(2 Corinthians 12:8–9)**.

## Also see

> “Erastus has remained at Corinth, and Trophimus I left sick in Miletus” **(2 Timothy 4:20)**.

> “And we know that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose” **(Romans 8:28)**.

> “My flesh and my heart may fail, but God is the strength of my heart and my portion forever” **(Psalm 73:26)**.

> “I know how to live humbly, and I know how to abound. I am accustomed to any and every situation—to being filled and being hungry, to having plenty and having need. I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength” **(Philippians 4:12–13)**.

## Common self-statements

- My illness is my fault for not believing enough.
- God would heal me if my faith were stronger.
- Other people have more faith than I do.
- I must be doing something wrong spiritually.
- If I admit I’m sick, I’m confessing doubt.
- God is disappointed in my weak faith.

## Common logical errors

- **Personalization:** Blaming your faith for an illness with many causes.
- **Overgeneralization:** Turning “God sometimes heals in answer to faith” into “God always heals when faith is enough.”
- **Comparison:** Measuring your faith by other people’s healing stories.
- **Mental filter:** Ignoring faithful people in Scripture who were not healed.

## Challenging questions

- Did Paul lack faith when his thorn was not removed?
- Why did Paul leave Trophimus sick?
- What did God say to Paul instead of healing him?
- Is my illness a measure of my faith, or part of living in a broken world?
- Can God be glorified through my weakness?
- Who taught me that faith always brings healing?
- What does it look like to trust God while I am still sick?

## Truth summary

> My illness is not proof that my faith is too weak. God can heal, and I can ask Him to. But even faithful people like Paul were not always healed. God's grace is sufficient for me, and His power is made perfect in my weakness. I can trust Him whether He heals me now, later, or in eternity.

## Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Sickness
- Faith
- Weakness
- Prayer, Answers to
- Strength

**Godly Counsel Lessons:**

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Suffering
- Prayer
- Weak/Tired

## Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

*Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"*

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "If I had enough faith, God would have healed me"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

**Name:** _____ **Date started:** _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

**"If I had enough faith, God would have healed me."** I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ Did Paul lack faith when he wasn't healed?
- ☐ Why was Trophimus left sick?
- ☐ What did God say instead of healing Paul?
- ☐ Is my illness a measure of my faith?
- ☐ Can God be glorified in my weakness?
- ☐ What does trusting God while sick look like?

**My own question:** _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ My illness is not a measure of my faith.
- ☐ God's grace is sufficient for me.
- ☐ God's power is perfected in my weakness.
- ☐ God works all things together for my good.
- ☐ I can ask for healing and trust God with the answer.
- ☐ God is the strength of my heart.

**In my own words:** _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- [ ] **2 Corinthians 12:8–9**
  *"Three times I pleaded with the Lord to take it away from me. But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."*
- [ ] **2 Timothy 4:20**
  *"Erastus has remained at Corinth, and Trophimus I left sick in Miletus."*
- [ ] **Romans 8:28**
  *"And we know that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose."*
- [ ] **Psalm 73:26**
  *"My flesh and my heart may fail, but God is the strength of my heart and my portion forever."*
- [ ] **Philippians 4:12–13**
  *"I know how to live humbly, and I know how to abound. I am accustomed to any and every situation—to being filled and being hungry, to having plenty and having need. I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength."*

**A verse I found myself:** _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# Practicing the Truth

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## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Grace log:** Each day, write one way God gave me strength or grace in my weakness.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, 2 Corinthians 12:9 becomes: "But He said to **Sarah**, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.'"*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Sickness" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

- ☐ **Read 2 Corinthians 12:7–10,** and write what Paul learned through his unanswered prayer.
- ☐ **Keep praying for healing,** and also pray, "Give me Your grace for today."
- ☐ **Continue your doctor's care** as part of trusting God, not as a lack of faith.
- ☐ **Talk with someone who has lived faithfully with illness** and ask how they experience God's grace.

**What I will do:** _____

**When:** _____

**What the lie predicts will happen:** _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

**What actually happened:** _____

**What I learned:** _____

**The lie** "If I had enough faith, God would have healed me": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | One way God gave me strength |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I had enough faith, God would have healed me.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Father, thank You that You can heal, and that Your grace is sufficient for me. Help me reject the lie that my illness continues because my faith is too weak. Give me strength in my weakness, peace in my waiting, and trust that You are working all things for my good. In Jesus' name, Amen.*

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*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*